Montserrat — day trip itinerary

From Barcelona · with transport, hours and booking links

Check before you plan. Museums and attractions that need advance tickets may be sold out — check availability via the ticket links first. Hours are typical and change by season; many museums close on Mondays.

Your first day trip: a jagged mountain silhouette an hour from the city, home to the Benedictine monastery of Santa Maria de Montserrat and the Black Madonna.

Before you go: check opening days and train/bus timetables, and book anything marked *Book ahead* — tickets, tours and seats may not be available on the day.

HOW TO GET THERE

Train: FGC line R5 from Plaça Espanya to Monistrol de Montserrat (or Montserrat-Aeri), then the Cremallera rack railway or the Aeri cable car up the mountain.

Change needed — swap from the train to the rack railway or cable car at the foot of the mountain.

Bus: No regular public bus line; the train + rack railway route above is the standard way in.

08:00 — **Depart Barcelona**

FGC line R5 from Plaça Espanya to Monistrol de Montserrat (or Montserrat-Aeri), then the Cremallera rack railway or Aeri cable car up the mountain.

🚇 About 1h15 door to door.

More info →

09:30 — **Basilica & the Black Madonna** FREE ENTRY

Montserrat's basilica and its famous statue of the Virgin — free to visit.

🚇 At the monastery complex.

Open in Google Maps →

10:30 — **Hike to Sant Jeroni viewpoint, or the Montserrat Museum** FREE ENTRY

Marked trails with panoramic Pyrenees views, or an indoor art collection if the weather turns.

🚇 Trailhead right by the monastery.

13:00 — **Lunch at Montserrat**

Self-service restaurant on site, or bring a picnic for the trail.

14:00 **Boys' choir performance (weekday afternoons) or more trail time**

FREE ENTRY

The Escolania boys' choir sings in the basilica most weekday afternoons — check the schedule on arrival.

16:30 **Funicular de Santa Cova or further walking** FREE ENTRY

A shorter funicular ride down to a chapel built into the rock face.

17:30 **Cremallera / cable car back to Monistrol, then FGC to Barcelona**

Reverse the morning's route.

🚇 About 1h15.

20:00 **Dinner back in Barcelona**

Arrive back with the evening free.

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